

REM2 Research Methods

Exercise 3 – 2: Property transaction records in London

Instructions: Work in groups of two to complete the following tasks

1. Read the “Small Home Data Deficit” Section on pages 1139 - 1140 of the following paper (full text available at Web of Science). Can you identify the data sources of the key variables – EPC rating and property transaction records?

Hubbard, P., J. Reades, H. Walter, and C. Preston. "Shrinking Homes? The Geographies of Small Domestic Properties in London, 2010-2021." *Environment and Planning B-Urban Analytics and City Science* 51, no. 5 (2024): 1137-52.

2. Go the Department of Levelling up, Housing & Community’s website. Download EPC data for London only. You will need to sign up if you are a new user. The process is straight-forward and access can be gained within minutes.

<https://epc.opendatacommunities.org/login>

3. Go to the HM Land Registry Open Data website to download residential property transaction records in London. Use the sampling period of Jan – September 2024.

<https://landregistry.data.gov.uk/app/ppd/>

4. Open the downloaded files in Excel. Observe the data. Note any missing values or outliers. Find the variable definitions in each file (Hint: Documentations).
5. Determine the type of the data - are these cross-sectional, time series, or panel data?
6. Use a software package of your choice, generate descriptive statistics of the variables in the two datasets.
7. Use a software package of your choice, visualise the distribution of house prices (i.e., histograms or pie charts) in London.
8. If you want to replicate this study by using data from Cambridge, can you find the data to support your analysis? Discuss.